

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 2
 ♥ A 7 6 4
 ♦ J 10 7 3
 ♣ 10 5

♠ A K 9 8 6 5

♥ 9

♦ A Q 6

♣ A K 2



♠ 10 3
 ♥ Q J 10 8
 ♦ K 8 2
 ♣ 9 7 6 4

♠ 7 4

♥ K 5 3 2

♦ 9 5 4

♣ Q J 8 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♥Q.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♥Q.

Losers: ♠ 1? : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 4?

That question mark means that if ♠s don't split 3-2 you will have 2 losers in which case the ♦ finesse will just have to work. However, the 3-2 split will probably occur, so you make your PLAN based on that.

Unless East is a complete moron dummy's ♥K is a goner no matter what you do. So you duck, then ruff the ♥J continuation. Next you play ♠A, ♠K, both defenders following. At this point one defender still holds the master ♠Q and you must decide whether to leave it outstanding or force them to play it.

When dummy has a side suit you want to run but no outside entries it usually pays to drive out the master trump. So you play another ♠ and West wins the ♠Q. He now plays a ♦ and you hopefully play the ♦Q, but East takes the ♦K and plays another ♦. You are now in control. Win the ♦A and play 4 rounds of ♣s, discarding your ♦ loser.

Imagine you had NOT driven out the ♠Q.

You would have played ♣A, ♣K, then a small ♣ to dummy's ♣J. West would ruff this with his ♠Q and you would never be able to reach dummy's ♣J. You would be down 1, losing 1 ♠, 1 ♥ and 2 ♦s.

With 22 points you are too strong to open with a 1-bid.

You start with a forcing 2♣, partner responds 2♦. This is a "waiting" bid, showing 0-7 points.

No need to jump. If you say anything other than 2NT partner is forced to bid again.

You bid 2♠ and it is partner who says 2NT.

Always keep in mind that you don't need to bid the same values twice. Partner knows that you have 22 or more points and knows that you have a good ♠ suit. So all you do at this point is rebid your ♠s to show that it is a 6-card suit.

You bid 3♠ and partner raises you to game.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 8 7 3

♥ 9 6 4

♦ A 8 5

♣ A K Q

♠ K J 2

♥ Q J 7 2

♦ 7 3

♣ 10 9 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 6 5 4

♥ A K 3

♦ 9 6 4 2

♣ J 8

♠ A Q

♥ 10 8 5

♦ K Q J 10

♣ 7 6 3 2

West

1 ♣

2 ♠

All Pass

2 ♠ by East

3 as long as the defenders don't get a ruff. But if the defender with a doubleton trump happened to get a ruff then your trump losers would go to 4. You should lead trumps to try to prevent this.

So win the ♦ A and lead a ♠. South will win and play 3 high ♦s. You ruff the third one in dummy. North may over-ruff, and if he does you can hope that he was the defender who started with 3 trumps. Suppose North now leads a ♥. You win in your hand and play another trump, happily observing the ♠ K and ♠ A both fall. You win the rest of the tricks, discarding your ♥ loser on dummy's third ♣.

When the defenders have a lot of high trumps you have to try to make sure they fall on the same tricks.

You were a little lucky that the defender who got the ruff, North, was the one who started with 3 trumps.

There are three legitimate choices, 1 ♦, 1 ♠ or 1NT.

You should always show a Major suit if you can, even a poor one like this.

You bid 1 ♠. Partner says 2 ♠ and

Partner has a minimum opener. You pass in a flash.

East plays 2 ♠. South leads the ♦ K.

East plays 2 ♠. South leads the ♦ K.

Losers: ♠ 3? : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2 : ♣ 0 : Total = 6?

Your ♥ loser can disappear on dummy's third ♣.

If ♠s split 3-2 you can hold your losers in the suit to 3 as long as the defenders don't get a ruff. But if the defender with a doubleton trump happened to get a ruff then your trump losers would go to 4. You should lead trumps to try to prevent this.